

MILESTONES**SETS PRECEDENT**

Accepts position as first female ophthalmologist at UCLA's Jules Stein Eye Institute in 1975.

KEY INVENTION

Completes the Laserphaco Probe in 1986; receives a patent for her invention 2 years later.

TRAINING DIRECTOR

In 1983, is first US woman to set up and direct an ophthalmology residency training program.

A pioneer for women in the field of ophthalmology, American Patricia Bath is an inventor, laser scientist, and ophthalmologist who has made huge global advances in the prevention of blindness.

Born in Harlem, New York, Patricia Bath studied medicine at Howard University and graduated in 1968. She was the first African American to complete a residency (postgraduate medical training) in ophthalmology at New York University, and went on to study corneal transplantation and keratoprosthesis (a procedure in which a cornea is replaced with an artificial one) at Columbia University. In 1974, she became associate professor of surgery and ophthalmology at UCLA and Charles R. Drew University. A fierce proponent of the idea that eyesight should be a basic human right, Bath co-founded the American Institute for the Prevention of Blindness in 1976 and launched "community ophthalmology," an outreach program bringing primary care to poor areas. In 1986, Bath invented the Laserphaco Probe, a laser that enabled more precise removal of cataracts. Bath lectured widely and continues to promote advanced ophthalmologic techniques, as well as provide vital, sight-saving treatments in developing nations.

"To restore sight is the ultimate reward."

Patricia Bath

PATRICIA

BATH

